



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

I just don't have time!



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What are some things you would do if you had more time?
- What are some things you used to do, but you don't now because you don't have enough time?

Can Do Statements

- I can express beliefs, opinions, and intention to do something.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.
- I can describe past habits.





Let's Explore!

Ted and Pamela talk about a **guru*** of time management.

* A "guru" is a person who is famous because of a special knowledge about something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Ted: Good evening, Pamela.

Pamela: Hi, Ted! Nice to see you back at Toastmasters. You had been attending meetings every month for a while last year. Then, you stopped.

Ted: Yes, I had been going regularly, but gave it up for a time. Now I'm back. Hopefully, I will stay this time.

Pamela: Why did you stop coming?

Ted: I had been trying to catch up on so many things. Between my work, family obligations and cooking meals, I didn't have any time left. I didn't know what to do.

Pamela: But you're here now, so what's changed?

Ted: It's interesting that you ask. Nobody told me how to organize time. I read a book by this guru of time management. It was a call to action for me. According to him, most people don't pay enough attention to establishing priorities. Too often, they pursue short-term goals. The trick is to move from doing what is urgent to what is important. I had been spending too much time putting out fires. I'm going to plan my time better from now on.

Pamela: Everyone has to eat. I'd say that is urgent.

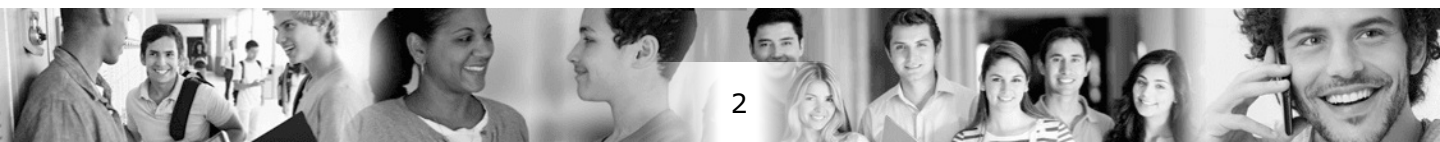
Ted: It only becomes urgent when you have nothing left in your fridge and all the stores are closed. What is important is planning your meals so you can reduce the time involved in shopping and cooking. The book explains very well what to do.

Pamela: Can you suggest where to get a copy of that book? I want to read it.

Ted: I'll lend you mine. Another secret is making routines that match your priorities, and sticking to them. For example, when you plan when and where you will exercise during the week, it frees up time and energy required to take action in other areas. I had been wasting a lot of time trying to do things without proper planning.

Pamela: I think you know what to say for your next Toastmaster's speech.

Ted: Yes. I'm up next, as a matter of fact.





Let's Practice!

Can you repeat what you said?

Instructions: Match the two halves to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|-----------------|
| 1) I _____ any time left. | a) didn't have |
| 2) I didn't _____ to do. | b) what to do |
| 3) Nobody told me _____ next time. | c) where to get |
| 4) Can you suggest _____ a copy of that book? | d) what to say |
| 5) I think you know _____ for your next Toastmaster's speech. | e) know what |



Let's Practice!

What had Pamela and Ted done in the past?

Instructions: Use the Words from the Word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

had been going regularly / had been spending / had been trying to catch / had been wasting / had been attending

- 1) I _____ up so many things.
- 2) You _____ meetings every month for a while last year.
- 3) I _____ too much time putting out fires.
- 4) I _____ a lot of time trying to do things without proper planning.
- 5) I _____ , but gave it up for a time.





Extension Activity

Make a list of useful time-saving techniques for busy people.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Identify the ways to save time presented in this lesson then make a list of them.
- With a partner, discuss other ways of saving time.
- Go online. Find 3 more ideas.
- Write a detailed list of suggestions to help people save time. For each suggestion, write 1 - 2 sentences giving examples.
- Read your list to your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss ways of saving time.

☐ ☐

I write suggestions for saving time and give examples.

☐ ☐

I read the list to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **call to action** (expression): a strong message to do something about a situation
e.g. I read a book by this guru of time management. It was a call to action for me.
- **to put out fires** (expression): to solve immediate, urgent problems
e.g. I had been spending too much time putting out fires.
- **the trick is** (expression): the secret way of doing something
e.g. The trick is to move from doing what is urgent to what is important.
- **routine** (noun): an action you do on a regular basis over a period of time (every day, every week, etc.)
e.g. Another secret is making routines that match your priorities, and sticking to them.
- **required** (adjective): necessary
e.g. When you plan your exercise routine, it frees up time and energy required for other things.
- **to take action** (verb): to do something
e.g. Planning is required to take action in other areas.





Learning Points

The Wh-Clause With Infinitives

You can make sentences with wh-clauses followed by the infinitive (to + verb).

You can use these sentences if you want to talk about ways or methods of doing something. Often, you can use **should** in these sentences as well.

*I'm not sure **what** to do with my hair for the wedding.*

*I'm not sure **what** I should do with my hair for the wedding.*

*The travel agent didn't know **how** to book the ticket online.*

*The travel agent didn't know **how** he should book the ticket online.*

Notice the use of the pronoun before **should**, followed by the base form of the verb (no "to"). This pronoun refers to the same subject that is in the main clause.

Examples:

- *I didn't know what to do.*
- *Nobody told me how to organize my time.*

Past Perfect Continuous for Habitual Actions

You can use the Past Perfect Continuous (also called the Past Perfect Progressive) when you want to describe a habit that occurred repeatedly over a period of time. This verb tense tells you that these habitual actions occurred before another time in the past.

You use the Past Perfect Continuous to talk about an action that happened repeatedly before another time or activity in the past.

Past Perfect Continuous form:

had + been + verb -ing

Examples:

*I didn't realize that I **had been wearing** the same outfit to work every week until my co-worker commented on my boring sense of style.*

*I **had been going** to the gym during my lunch hour for months until my work schedule changed and I wasn't able to go anymore.*

Examples:

- *I had been spending too much time putting out fires.*
- *I had been wasting a lot of time trying to do things without proper planning.*

